

RAJWANT RAWAT

MAN ON A MISSION
UN Climate Change High-Level Champion, Dr Mahmoud Mohieldin, in Delhi

INTERVIEW

"DISASTER-HIT NATIONS NEED ACTION, NOT NICE SPEECHES"

The 2022 United Nations Climate Change Conference, referred to as COP27, is being held from November 6 to 18 at the Egyptian resort of Sharm El-Sheikh. With the devastating impact of climate change already being felt, COP27 will focus on implementation, whether it is adaptation, mitigation or building resilience. Finance and technology are crucial, with developed countries not meeting their targets to provide adaptation funds and the private sector yet to move in a big way to cash in on green projects. Economist **Dr MAHMOUD MOHIELDIN**, *a former Egyptian minister and former senior vice president at the World Bank, is the UN Climate Change High-Level Champion, whose focus is on getting non-state actors, particularly corporate houses, to invest in green technologies in a big way that could turn the tide in the fight to save the planet. On a recent visit to Delhi, Mohieldin spoke to Group Editorial Director* **RAJ CHENGAPPA** *on his priorities. Excerpts:*

Q. What would you like COP27 to achieve when it meets in November at Sharm El-Sheikh?
A. Adaptation to climate change needs to be the winner at COP27. This would need finance, investment and projects to be highlighted. This is an implementation summit that needs to come up with practical solutions for disaster risk management. Unfortunately, when it comes to loss and damage funds, the issue is lost in endless discussions. I hope this will be tackled properly by the state actors in their negotiations. Otherwise, the role of non-state actors, who are a catalyst force and whom I represent, would be very much constrained.

Q. Pakistan was devastated by floods recently; other developing nations have also been hit by freak weather patterns. What can the international community do to compensate for the loss?
A. Two things. One, we need to recognise the importance of the loss and mobilise funds to help these countries. Secondly, we must expedite work in mitigation in order to reduce emissions and to do more on resilience to minimise the impact of such disasters. Developing countries cannot afford to do it on their own. It calls for international cooperation. It will not be solved by nice speeches but by action on supplying finance and technology and improving capacity development.

Q. Developed countries had committed $100 billion annually for adaptation funds. Yet most reports say they have not even met half their commitments. Is it game over for the world?
A. COP27 needs to ensure that developed countries meet their commitments. But we must realise that even if the full $100 billion is delivered, that would still be no more than three per cent of what is

> **"THE UKRAINE WAR HAS ALSO DIVERSIFIED ENERGY SOURCES BY INVESTMENT IN WIND, SOLAR AND GREEN HYDROGEN"**